

Yes. If you want to learn **U.S. commercial insurance without paying**, there are several genuinely useful resources. I'd prioritize these rather than trying to find random YouTube courses.

1. The Institutes — free sample courses

The Institutes free courses

This is probably the best place to start. They currently offer free sample courses for **AINS**, **AU (Commercial Underwriting)**, **CPCU**, **AIC**, **ARM**, and others. The Institutes+1

For commercial insurance, I'd specifically take:

- **AINS sample** — insurance fundamentals
- **AU sample** — commercial underwriting
- **CPCU 530 sample** — insurance/legal fundamentals
- **AIC sample** — claims fundamentals

The AINS sample is particularly good if you're starting from scratch. The Institutes

Free AU / Commercial Underwriting sample

Free CPCU 530 sample

2. IRMI — free membership

Free IRMI membership

IRMI is extremely useful for learning **how commercial insurance actually works**.

A free IRMI membership gives you access to:

- **AINS sample** — insurance fundamentals
- **AU sample** — commercial underwriting
- **CPCU 530 sample** — insurance/legal fundamentals

- **AIC sample** — claims fundamentals
- Free webinars and recordings
- White papers
- Industry reports
- Newsletters
- Free expert commentary
- Glossary
- Periodic access to selected paid content Irm

Their topics include:

- Commercial Property
- Commercial Liability
- Commercial Auto
- Specialty Lines
- Claims
- Risk Financing
- Construction
- Workers' Compensation

IRMI insurance resources

Important: IRMI's full *Insurance Coverage Essentials* resource is paid, so don't assume everything on IRMI is free. The free membership itself, however, provides quite a lot. IRMI Subscription+1

3. NAIC — free U.S. insurance regulatory material

NAIC

Use the **National Association of Insurance Commissioners** to understand the U.S. regulatory environment.

Focus on:

- Insurance regulation
- State insurance departments
- Producer licensing
- Insurer financial regulation
- Market conduct
- Consumer protection
- Insurance terminology

This is especially useful if you're outside the U.S. and need to understand why U.S. insurance operates differently from many other countries.

4. Insurance Information Institute — free educational material

Insurance Information Institute

The III is useful for learning the **big picture** of insurance and risk.

It's particularly good for understanding:

4. Insurance Information Institute — free educational material

- Commercial insurance

- Property risks
- Liability
- Catastrophe risk
- Workers' compensation
- Cyber risk
- Insurance industry economics
- Current insurance issues

I would use this alongside the more technical Institutes/IRMI material.

5. IRMI glossary — excellent free reference

IRMI

When you encounter an unfamiliar term, IRMI's glossary is one of the first places I'd check.

For example:

- Additional insured
- Aggregate limit
- Coinsurance
- Deductible
- Occurrence
- Claims-made
- SIR
- Subrogation

- Waiver of subrogation
- Primary and noncontributory
- Indemnification
- Completed operations
- Business income

This is particularly useful once you start reading actual policies.

6. YouTube — useful, but be selective

YouTube can be very good for visual explanations of insurance concepts, especially:

- CGL explained
- Commercial property
- Businessowners policy
- Commercial auto
- Workers' compensation
- Claims-made vs occurrence
- Additional insured
- Umbrella vs excess
- Insurance underwriting

But I wouldn't use YouTube as your **primary authority**. Use it to understand a concept, then verify the technical details against The Institutes, IRMI, ISO forms, or regulatory sources.

My recommended completely free path

If you don't want to spend \$1, I'd do this:

Weeks 1–2: Insurance fundamentals

Start with the free **AINS sample**.

Learn:

- What insurance is
- Risk
- Insurer
- Insured
- Agent
- Broker
- Underwriter
- Claim
- Premium
- Deductible
- Limit
- Retention
- Reinsurance

Weeks 3–4: Commercial insurance

Take the free **AU sample** and start studying:

- Commercial Property

- CGL
- Commercial Auto
- Workers' Comp
- BOP
- Umbrella/Excess

Weeks 5–6: Policy language

Use IRMI's free material and learn:

Declarations → Insuring Agreement → Definitions → Conditions → Exclusions → Endorsements → Limits

Then learn:

- Occurrence vs. claims-made
- Additional insured
- Waiver of subrogation
- Primary/noncontributory
- SIR vs deductible
- Aggregate vs per-occurrence limits

Weeks 7–8: Real-world insurance

Start reading IRMI webinars, white papers and industry material. Irmi

At this point, don't just ask *"What does CGL mean?"*

Start asking:

A company has this exposure. What policy responds? What doesn't respond? Why? What exclusions apply? What endorsement changes the answer?

That's where commercial insurance starts becoming practical.

If you want the best free resources specifically for commercial underwriting

I'd narrow it down even further:

1. **The Institutes – AU free sample** → underwriting fundamentals The Institutes
2. **The Institutes – AINS free sample** → overall insurance foundation The Institutes
3. **IRMI free membership** → commercial insurance terminology and real-world issues Irmi
4. **NAIC** → U.S. regulatory framework
5. **ISO/AAIS policy forms and endorsements** → eventually learn the actual policy language
6. **YouTube** → visual reinforcement, not primary authority

If you tell me whether you're learning this for **commercial underwriting, insurance operations/BPO, claims, broking, or an IT/insurance role**, I can give you a **100% free 30-day learning plan with specific resources for each day**.